



Prow (front) of boat shaped to a point to cut through water

Dugout canoe Haiti

Panels of birch bark, waterproofed with resin from spruce trees, sewn together



Bark canoe North America

Frame made from branches of willow



Currach Ireland

Simple oar made from ash wood

Currachs are still used for **fishing** and **fun races** in Ireland and Scotland.

Quffa Iraq



Hull made from woven reeds and rope, sometimes covered in bitumen (tar)

Thung-chai Vietnam



Rim of boat is made of bamboo

Sides lashed to bottom of hull with flax fibre and decorated with bird feathers

Stern covered with ceremonial designs



Maori war canoe New Zealand

bark canoes out of a wooden frame covered in tree bark. Reeds, which grow in abundance at the edges of many rivers and lakes, were dried, bound, and woven to form **reed boats**. Reeds could also be woven to form circular boats for fishing. Known as **Thung-chai** in Vietnam, and

coracles in UK, a similar form of boat called a **Quffa** existed in Iraq for at least 5,000 years. The ancient Egyptians built reed boats to sail the Nile River; around 5,500 years ago, they began to build larger, wooden **seagoing boats** to venture beyond the Nile into the Mediterranean Sea.